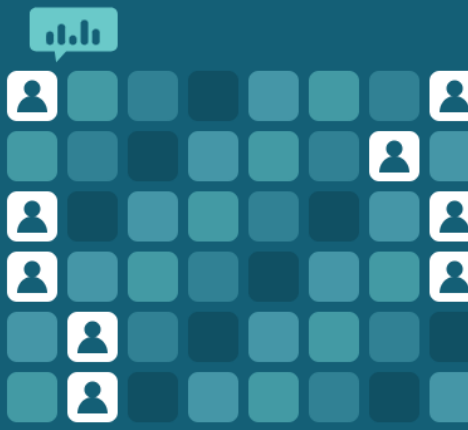
Place-based data training

Activities workbook

Module 3.2: Data ecosystem mapping and custodian engagement



This training brings together practical guidance for using data in place-based work. It draws on PLACE and Seer Data's work alongside place-based initiatives across Australia.

The training covers the journey many place-based initiatives go on – from finding and accessing data to sharing it, making sense of it with community and using it to support local decisions and action.

Who is it for?

It is designed for people working in or supporting place-based initiatives. You might be new to working with data or already using and managing data as part of your everyday rhythm.

How to use this workbook

Throughout the training, you'll find opportunities to reflect on your work and consider how the ideas and tools apply in your place or initiative. This workbook brings together the activities for this module.

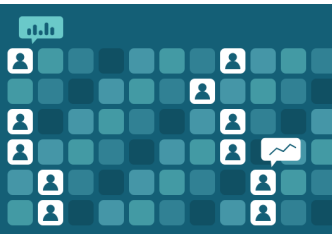
You can work through the training from beginning to end, or choose the modules most relevant to your role, experience and current work. We recommend starting with Welcome to place-based data training. You can return to other sections as you need them.

You can also connect with others doing the training to ask questions, share what you're learning and learn from their experience on PLACExCHANGE at **pxc.placeaustralia.org**.

A collaboration between

PLACE
Partnerships for Local Action & Community Empowerment

Seer
Data & Analytics



Understanding & using data together

Module

3.2 Data ecosystem mapping and custodian engagement

Section 1	Map the ecosystem, and find who holds the data	2 activities
Section 2	Ask well and understand what no means	2 activities
Section 3	From trust to agreement	2 activities

Try this now: map one question to its data

Apply | Apply to your place 1

Take one question you need answered at the moment, the kind a colleague or community member has asked you. Fill in the row below. In the second column, name which of the four data types would answer it. In the fourth, say how you will check whether it is already public.

The question I need answered	Type of place-based data	Who is likely to hold it	Open or private, and how I will check	What it would let us do

Example you can use

No live question right now? Use this one: “How many local families waited more than a month for a housing support appointment last year?”

Try this now: find the way to one custodian

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Take the custodian you named in the first exercise and work out how you would reach them. You are not sending anything yet. You are working out how to approach them and what rules apply.

Custodian	Data I want	Already published anywhere?	How to ask (open portal, Dataplace, direct request, ethics or research governance)	Rules that apply	My first step, and by when

Example you can use

No live request? Use this one: a state government department holds waiting time data for a local service, and you want it broken down by suburb.

Try this now: write the purpose, then test it

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Write the purpose of your request in plain language, then check it against the list. If you cannot answer a row, that row is your next piece of work.

Your purpose, in one or two sentences a community member would understand:

Check	Can you answer yes?
Clear purpose: can I explain why this data is needed?	
Defined use: do I know how it will be analysed and used?	
Right access: is it clear who will access it and how it is protected?	
Decision-focused: do I know what decisions or actions it will inform?	
Community benefit: can I explain how this helps the community or place?	
Safety and storage: can I explain how the data will be governed and safely stored?	
Minimal request: am I only asking for the data that is genuinely needed?	
Plain language: can I explain the purpose in simple, non-technical language?	

> If you cannot explain the purpose clearly to a community member or a data custodian, the request is not ready yet.

Try this now: plan the conversation before the request

Apply | Apply to your place 2

Take the custodian you identified in Section 1, or the one you are closest to approaching, and plan the conversation that happens before anything formal is submitted. The third column is the one people skip: write down what you want to learn from them, not only what you want to get.

Who I am, and who I represent	Who else is involved	What I want to understand from them	Limits or risks I will name upfront	What I will do if the answer is no

Example you can use

No live request? Use this one: you are approaching a local service provider for de-identified appointment waiting times, on behalf of a partnership of three organisations.

Try this now: plan what you give back

Apply | Apply to your place 1

Take the custodian from your request and plan the reciprocity before you need it. This is often what decides whether there is a second request.

What I will share back	Who it goes to	When, and how often	How I will credit their contribution	Something useful I can offer easily

Example you can use

No live request? Use this one: a service provider has agreed to share de-identified waiting time data with your partnership for twelve months.

Try this now: draft the outline of an agreement

Apply Apply to your place 2

You are not writing a legal document. You are writing the six things a partner would need to agree with you before anyone brings in a template. Each row maps to one of the MOU points above.

Part of the agreement	Your draft
Shared purpose: why we are working together	
Community benefit: what changes for people here	
Guiding principles: the values this partnership works to	
Roles: who does what, and who is accountable	
Governance: who decides, and how community voice is included	
Review: what will trigger us revisiting this, and when	

Example you can use

No live request? Use this one: a partnership of three organisations and a service provider, sharing de-identified appointment data for twelve months to understand local waiting times.